



eBike and Log 9 Materials

Electric bike Log 9 Materials join hands for their first collaboration in the form of the Velocipede. <https://digit.in/jun22-54>



Stratolaunch's first hypersonic

Stratolaunch is readying to test a hypersonic vehicle that will launch from the huge Roc carrier aircraft. <https://digit.in/jun22-55>

DIY Mechanical Keyboard Workshop

Time to upgrade from the regular old keyboards, time to go custom!

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C

lack clackity clack clack, Oh hi! We were just testing out our newly built keyboard! What's

that? How did we make it? Oh, don't worry we'll teach you! But before we give you a crash course in building your own keyboard, let us first give you a simple revision of what goes into building a keyboard? Sound good? Alright then, here we go!

INTRODUCTION TO KEYBOARDS

So, what exactly are keyboards? No not the small puny keys that stick out of your laptop. We don't talk about that. Do you remember those keyboards that were big behemoths with full-size keys sticking out of the casing? The ones which you could hit someone on the head with? Yeah the ones from the olden times, THOSE are the ones we will be talking about.

IBM's Model M is said to be the first-ever mechanical keyboard. It was, and is still known as the king of click! It was so well received by the people that IBM started to sell them as an accessory to all their PCs. The same format remained popular and the original QWERTY layout has managed to stick around the longest.

It even made its way on our phones, which don't even have physical keys anymore!.

Though its structure was very different compared to the modern mechanical keyboard, it is known to be the inspiration for people to pursue the feeling of tangibility in their clicks

TYPES OF KEYBOARDS

While in the olden days, you only had one choice in terms of size and the type of keys you would get, modern-day mechanical keyboard manufacturers make sure they give their consumers a plethora of choices in terms of size, types of switches, and even aesthetics.

Size

The size of keys and keyboard is a matter of personal preference for people. Some like their keyboards to be full sized with a dedicated number pad, while others like theirs to be as small as possible.

There are 3 industry accepted size presets - the full size 100 per cent, the 80 per cent TKL, and the 60 per cent.

1. 100 per cent / Full Size - The full-size keyboard pretty much explains itself, it comprises all

the 104 keys that were originally featured on the Model M and has a dedicated number pad usually on the right hand side.

2. The TKL/80 per cent - TKL stands for "Ten Key Less". Keyboards following this size factor work without the number pad but are still bigger than the other formats.

3. 60 per cent - Lastly, there are the 60 per cent keyboards which are the smallest of them all. They cut down on less essential keys and assign those functions to keys that are already present on the keyboard. You can usually utilise them by pressing down the Fn key and then pressing the subsequent key whose function you want to activate.

There are also lesser-known formats such as the 75 per cent and other odd sizes which are mostly used by enthusiasts.

Switches

There are multiple types of switches featured in mechanical keyboards that can be categorised into three major categories.

1. Clicky - These switches take after the Model M and try to live up to